

CFD Assignment 2

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I. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Consider a physical domain between an ellipse (with semi-major axis a 1 m and semi-minor axis 0.5 m) and far field boundary located at 20m as shown in the Figure 1. A structured computational grid of size 101×81 is to be generated, where there are 101 points in the ξ -direction and 81 points in the η -direction.

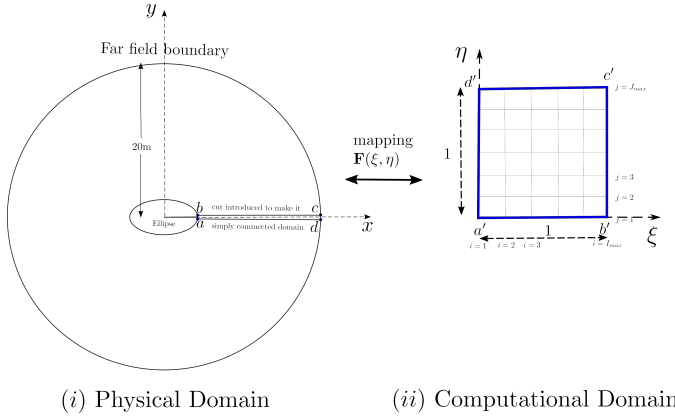


Figure 1: Problem Statement

The physical grid is obtained using the **Transfinite Interpolation (TFI)** method, ensuring smooth mapping between computational coordinates (ξ, η) and the physical domain (x, y) .

The computational coordinates are defined as follows:

- $\xi \in [0, 1]$ represents the angular distribution along the boundary of the ellipse and the far-field circle.
- $\eta \in [0, 1]$ controls the radial stretching, transitioning from the elliptical inner boundary to the circular outer boundary.

II. IMPLEMENTATION

A. Derivations

The mapping function $\mathbf{F}(\xi, \eta) = (x(\xi, \eta), y(\xi, \eta))$ is constructed using transfinite interpolation.

Physical domain:

- **Inner boundary (ellipse):**

$$x_{\text{inner}} = a \cos \theta, \quad y_{\text{inner}} = b \sin \theta, \quad \theta \in [0, 2\pi]$$

- **Outer boundary (circle):**

$$x_{\text{outer}} = R \cos \theta, \quad y_{\text{outer}} = R \sin \theta, \quad \theta \in [0, 2\pi]$$

$$\mathbf{F}(\xi, \eta) = \begin{bmatrix} x(\xi, \eta) \\ y(\xi, \eta) \end{bmatrix}$$

Computational Domain:

- **Corner Points:**

$$\mathbf{F}(0, 0) = \begin{bmatrix} a \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{F}(1, 0) = \begin{bmatrix} a \\ 0 \end{bmatrix},$$

$$\mathbf{F}(0, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{F}(1, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

- **Edges:**

$$\mathbf{F}(\xi, 0) = \begin{bmatrix} a \cos(2\pi\xi) \\ b \sin(2\pi\xi) \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{F}(0, \eta) = \begin{bmatrix} (1-\eta)a + \eta R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\mathbf{F}(\xi, 1) = \begin{bmatrix} R \cos(2\pi\xi) \\ R \sin(2\pi\xi) \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{F}(1, \eta) = \begin{bmatrix} (1-\eta)a + \eta R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Using TFI, the mapping function is expressed as:[1]

$$\begin{aligned} P_\xi[\mathbf{F}(\eta)] &= (1-\xi)\mathbf{F}(0, \eta) + \xi\mathbf{F}(1, \eta) \\ &= (1-\xi) \begin{bmatrix} (1-\eta)a + \eta R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + \xi \begin{bmatrix} (1-\eta)a + \eta R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} P_\eta[\mathbf{F}(\xi)] &= (1-\eta)\mathbf{F}(\xi, 0) + \eta\mathbf{F}(\xi, 1) \\ &= (1-\eta) \begin{bmatrix} a \cos(2\pi\xi) \\ b \sin(2\pi\xi) \end{bmatrix} + \eta \begin{bmatrix} R \cos(2\pi\xi) \\ R \sin(2\pi\xi) \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} P_\xi P_\eta(\mathbf{F}) &= (1-\xi)(1-\eta)\mathbf{F}(0, 0) + (1-\xi)\eta\mathbf{F}(0, 1) \\ &\quad + \xi(1-\eta)\mathbf{F}(1, 0) + \xi\eta\mathbf{F}(1, 1) \\ &= (1-\xi)(1-\eta) \begin{bmatrix} a \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + (1-\xi)\eta \begin{bmatrix} R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \\ &\quad + \xi(1-\eta) \begin{bmatrix} a \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + \xi\eta \begin{bmatrix} R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

TFI Expression:[1]

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{F}(\xi, \eta) &= P_\xi[\mathbf{F}(\eta)] \oplus P_\eta[\mathbf{F}(\xi)] \\ &= P_\xi[\mathbf{F}(\eta)] + P_\eta[\mathbf{F}(\xi)] - P_\xi P_\eta(\mathbf{F}) \end{aligned}$$

Substituting we get:

$$\mathbf{F}(\xi, \eta) = (1 - \xi) \begin{bmatrix} (1 - \eta)a + \eta R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + \xi \begin{bmatrix} (1 - \eta)a + \eta R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \\ + (1 - \eta) \begin{bmatrix} a \cos(2\pi\xi) \\ b \sin(2\pi\xi) \end{bmatrix} + \eta \begin{bmatrix} R \cos(2\pi\xi) \\ R \sin(2\pi\xi) \end{bmatrix} \\ - \left\{ (1 - \xi)(1 - \eta) \begin{bmatrix} a \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + (1 - \xi)\eta \begin{bmatrix} R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \right. \\ \left. + \xi(1 - \eta) \begin{bmatrix} a \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + \xi\eta \begin{bmatrix} R \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$$

Simplyfying we get:

$$\mathbf{F}(\xi, \eta) = \begin{bmatrix} x(\xi, \eta) \\ y(\xi, \eta) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \cos(2\pi\xi) & 0 \\ 0 & \sin(2\pi\xi) \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} (1 - \eta)a + \eta R \\ (1 - \eta)b + \eta R \end{bmatrix}$$

$$x(\xi, \eta) = \cos(2\pi\xi)[(1 - \eta)a + \eta R]$$

$$y(\xi, \eta) = \sin(2\pi\xi)[(1 - \eta)b + \eta R]$$

B. Coding

The [Python script](#) generates a structured computational grid using the **Transfinite Interpolation (TFI)** method. This approach ensures a smooth mapping between computational coordinates (ξ, η) and physical domain coordinates (x, y) . The implementation follows the following sequence of steps, outlined below:

- 1) **Defining the Grid Resolution:** The number of grid points in the ξ and η directions is set to 101 and 81, respectively.
- 2) **Defining Boundaries:** The semi-major and semi-minor axes of the ellipse (inner boundary) and the radius of the outer circular boundary are specified.
- 3) **Discretization of Computational Coordinates:** The computational coordinates ξ and η are evenly spaced in the $[0, 1]$ range using `numpy.linspace`.
- 4) **Initializing the Grid Arrays:** Two 2D arrays, x and y , are initialized to store the physical coordinates of the grid points.
- 5) **Mapping from Computational to Physical Space:**
 - The x and y coordinates of each grid point are computed using the TFI method.
 - The radial stretching (η) interpolates between the inner elliptical boundary and the outer circular boundary.
 - The angular distribution (ξ) ensures a smooth transition along the elliptical and circular boundaries.
- 6) **Grid Visualization:**
 - Blue lines represent constant ξ values (grid lines in the η direction).
 - Red lines represent constant η values (grid lines in the ξ direction).
 - An imaginary cut line at $\theta = 0$ is marked with a dashed black line.
 - Four key points (a, b, c, d) are highlighted on the inner and outer boundaries.

7) **Plot Formatting:** The grid is displayed using Matplotlib, with appropriate labels, equal aspect ratio, and grid styling.

The final output is a structured computational grid, ensuring a smooth mapping from computational space (ξ, η) to physical space (x, y) . The generated grid is saved as an image file `generated_grid.png`.

III. RESULT

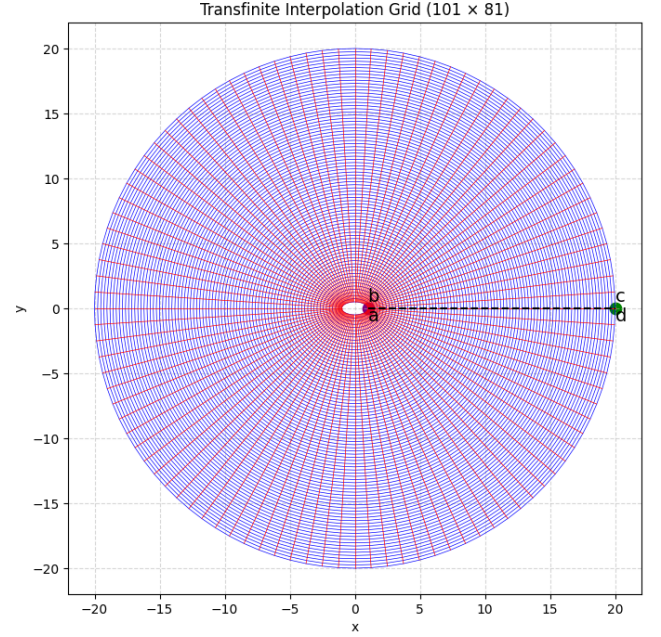


Figure 2: Generated Grid

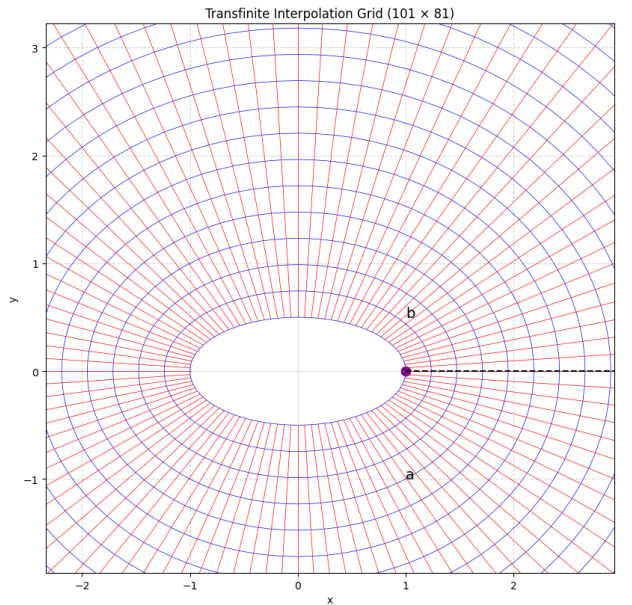


Figure 3: Zoomed View of the grid

APPENDIX A CODE

A. Code for grid generation

```

1 import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
2 import numpy as np
3
4 # Define the grid size
5 num_xi = 101 # Number of points in the xi-direction
6 num_eta = 81 # Number of points in the eta-direction
7
8 # Define the semi-major and semi-minor axes for the ellipse (inner boundary)
9 a = 1.0
10 b = 0.5
11
12 # Define the radius for the circle (outer boundary)
13 R_outer = 20.0
14
15 # Generate xi and eta values
16 xi = np.linspace(0, 1, num_xi)
17 eta = np.linspace(0, 1, num_eta)
18
19 # Initialize x and y grid arrays
20 x = np.zeros((num_eta, num_xi))
21 y = np.zeros((num_eta, num_xi))
22
23 # Compute the grid points using TFI
24 for i in range(num_eta):
25     for j in range(num_xi):
26         x[i, j] = np.cos(2 * np.pi * xi[j]) * ((1 - eta[i]) * a + eta[i] * R_outer)
27         y[i, j] = np.sin(2 * np.pi * xi[j]) * ((1 - eta[i]) * b + eta[i] * R_outer)
28
29 # Plot the grid
30 plt.figure(figsize=(10, 8))
31 for i in range(num_eta):
32     plt.plot(x[i, :], y[i, :], "b-", linewidth=0.5) # Lines along xi
33 for j in range(num_xi):
34     plt.plot(x[:, j], y[:, j], "r-", linewidth=0.5) # Lines along eta
35
36 # Add imaginary cut line (dashed line along theta = 0)
37 plt.plot(
38     [x[0, 0], x[-1, 0]],
39     [y[0, 0], y[-1, 0]],
40     "k--",
41     linewidth=1.5,
42     label="Imaginary Cut ( $\theta = 0$ )",
43 )
44
45 # Highlight Point a and b
46 plt.scatter(x[0, 0], y[0, 0], color="purple", s=80, label="Point a/b")
47 plt.text(x[0, 0], y[0, 0] + 0.5, "b", fontsize=14, color="black")
48 plt.text(x[0, 0], y[0, 0] - 1.0, "a", fontsize=14, color="black")
49
50 # Highlight Point c and d
51 plt.scatter(x[-1, 0], y[-1, 0], color="green", s=80, label="Point d/c")
52 plt.text(x[-1, 0], y[-1, 0] + 0.5, "c", fontsize=14, color="black")
53 plt.text(x[-1, 0], y[-1, 0] - 1.0, "d", fontsize=14, color="black")
54

```

```
55 plt.gca().set_aspect("equal")
56 plt.title("Transfinite Interpolation Grid (101 x 81)")
57 plt.xlabel("x")
58 plt.ylabel("y")
59 plt.grid(True, linestyle="--", alpha=0.5)
60 plt.savefig("generated_grid.png")
61 plt.show()
```

APPENDIX B SOURCE

REFERENCES

- [1] T. J. Chung, *Computational Fluid Dynamics*. Cambridge University Press, 2010.